



Journey into the spirit of Islam
An artistic imagination



Presenting a new imagination for experiencing Abu Dhabi and the spirit of Islam.

As a journey through a map of treasures

The journey begins when someone first enters Abu Dhabi at the airport and ends at their departure from the country.

They leave:

- a. **Inspired** - By beautiful art
- b. **Informed** - With a deeper understanding and first-hand experience of the values of Islam
- c. **Instagrammed** - Created and shared unique memories in Abu Dhabi



Unlike most public artwork, these art experiences are

Beautiful and awe-inspiring

Invite visitor participation

Reflect one of Islam's core values

Can be captured and shared

This presentation is a creative imagination for how we would go about using art to rebrand Islam and experience it as a journey. It does not necessarily showcase the actual installations. The final art pieces will be created at a later stage.

The Journey begins at the airport (at immigration)



The beginning

- At immigration, each visitor to Abu Dhabi receives a unique, interactive, passport-sized book containing a treasure map of Abu Dhabi,
- The book serves two purposes: it a reference guide to learn about Abu Dhabi's values and the “treasures” and a means to document memories and reflections from a visitor's journey.
- The book itself is a soulful work of art. This way it differentiates itself clearly from a travel guide or a tourism pamphlet. The book is treated as sacred and will contain no advertising or sponsorship.
- The book contains a commemorative coin and an interactive map that changes color and reveals additional information someone scratches out a visited destination.



Experiencing Sadaqah (Charity, Generosity & Kindness)



The more you give, the more the flower opens

Experiencing Sadaqah (Charity, Generosity & Kindness)

“Every act of goodness is Sadaqah.”

Value:

The spirit of generosity, kindness and giving

Art:

A flower sculpture that opens when people are caring and generous

Experience:

- Residents and visitors participate to give through a website. Each petal stands for a specific cause/charity category and the more that is donated to that cause, the more that particular petal opens. The full flower opens when the community's total fundraising goal is met, with an accompanying celebration.
- The installation is surrounded by water and there are music and lighting components which can change over time and during special occasions when the flower opens (e.g. New Year's Eve ball dropping in New York City).
- The full flower can also be opened by making a donation of a larger amount on-site via a donation booth or app/website. Donations can be dedicated to someone and directed to specific causes or charities.

The Adhan - The Call of the Conscience



Sculptures that sing with the wind

The Adhan - The Call of the Conscience

Value:

Making Islam relatable to both believers and non-believers through the call of oneness. A call to gather oneself - we may come from different parts of the world but the sound unites us

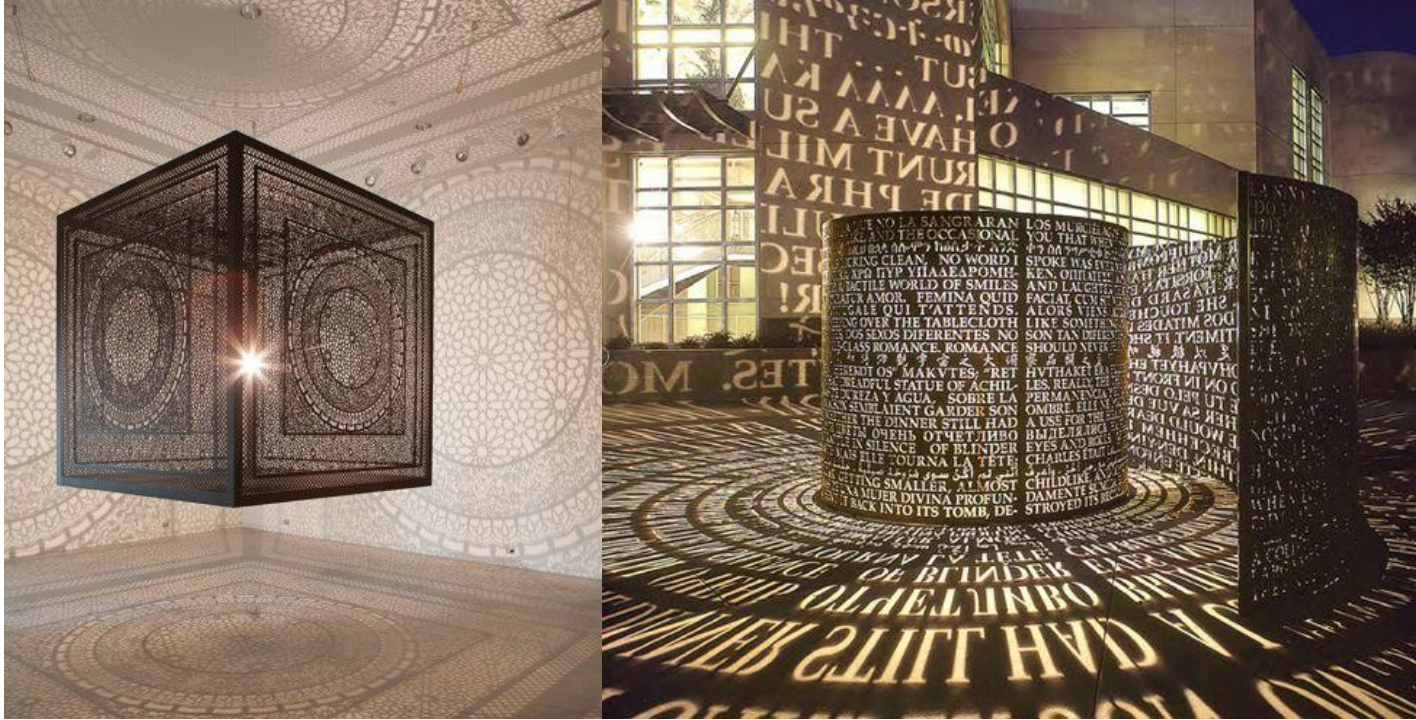
Art:

A wind sculpture that opens at given times and sings with the wind

Experience:

- There is a sacredness, stillness and silent awareness when the wind sculpture is turned on at special times
- There is a royal association, with the royal household holding the keys to it as well as determining the right times and recipients for this to be a gift to other nations.
- The idea behind gifting it is to reinforce how sound can unite us, how Islam stands for Peace. So there is an Adhan happening in every time zone across the world at any given time.

Experiencing Tawheed (Oneness) through Sacred Geometry & calligraphy



Projections of Islamic calligraphy as well as those from other languages

Experiencing Tawheed (Oneness) through Sacred Geometry & calligraphy

Value:

Experiencing

- Oneness through Sacred Geometry & calligraphy and
- Frugality - light has the power to transform buildings

Art:

A small, frugal sculpture with a powerful light source transforming the entire landscape. Shadow and light, seeming opposites, come together to create a magical world and an immersive experience. The sculpture features calligraphy of words that have significance in Islam and that are translated into other languages or sacred islamic geometry.

Experience:

- The sculpture has six faces that are removable and changeable, bringing freshness to the sculpture on a regular basis.
- This installation will travel across Abu Dhabi and other places and can change as it travels.
- It invites interaction - one side of the cube has a blank frame that invites viewers to create their own shadow art. Props can be provided near the installation and workshops can be offered in the community to play with shadows.
- A hashtag is used to encourage social media posts across the world and show what viewers have created. There can be contests and giveaways

Experiencing Symmetry and Order through Islamic geometry



Journey to the center of a labyrinth while reflecting on meaningful questions at various turns

Experiencing Symmetry and Order through Islamic geometry

Value:

Experiencing Symmetry and Order through Islamic geometry

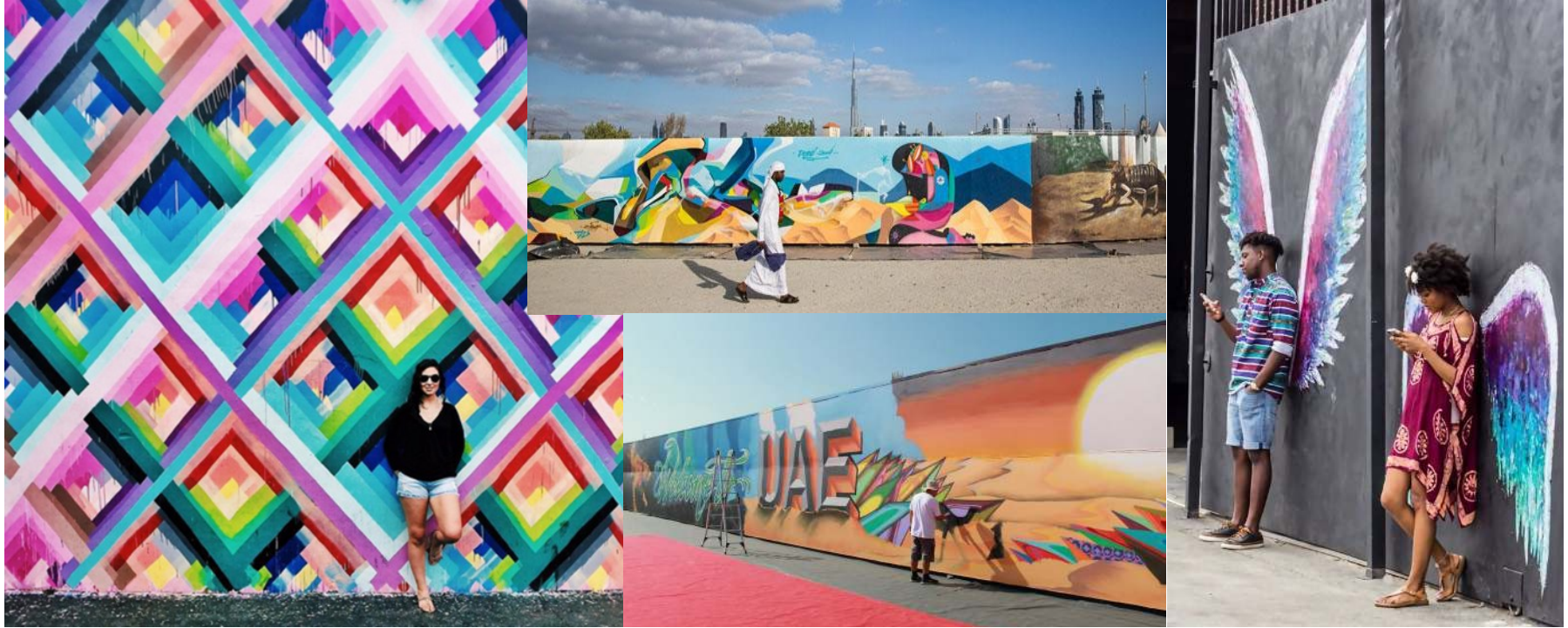
Art:

A beautiful outdoor labyrinth which encourages a journey to one's center rather than seeking a way out of a maze

Experience:

- A labyrinth constructed with a question for reflection at every turn and walls full of art and poetry, possibly with augmented/virtual reality components and accompanying music. The entry-way is through a labyrinth of mirrors to help discern the difference between illusion and the truth and then take a journey to one's center.
- The labyrinth gets tougher and tougher as you go closer to the center. Each traveler to the center performs a ritual there – leaving behind something they would like to shed by offering it into an urn at the center of the labyrinth.

Walls of Jihaad - striving for a personal promise



Using murals and social media to add your voice and make a promise to yourself

Walls of Jihaad - striving for a personal promise

“Declare your jihaad on thirteen enemies you cannot see - egoism, arrogance, conceit, selfishness, greed, lust, intolerance, anger, lying, cheating, gossiping and slandering. If you can master and destroy them, then you will be ready to fight the enemy you can see.”

-Al Ghazali

Value:

(Jihad - fighting an inner struggle - what are you willing to let go of to do the right thing. Physical, Spiritual, Moral and Mental effort.) Self Discipline - A promise to stand for/by something

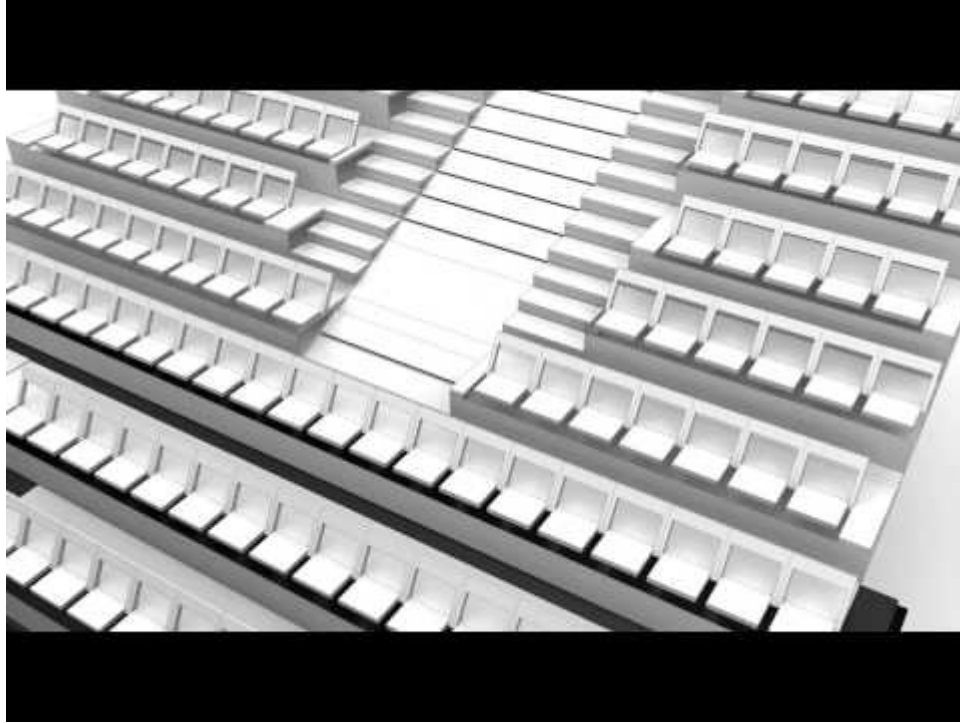
Art:

Larger than life, fun, awe-inspiring murals across Abu Dhabi called the “Walls of Jihaad – striving for a personal promise/commitment.

Experience:

- Abu Dhabi signature, Selfie walls where participants take a picture against a mural that inspires them to strive for something larger and stand by a promise they make to themselves.
- Hashtags and social media posts to make a public promise of their own personal Jihaad
- The murals contain sections with –
 - Blank spaces and interesting questions where people can express their views or Parts of the murals could be a question for people to chalk in their answer
 - Papers to write your wishes/promises and put into holes in the wall

Experiencing Stories through: The modern campfire



Using pop-up theaters and travelling storytellers that share stories inspired by the spirit of Islam.

Further thoughts

Value:

Reviving the ancient islamic art of storytelling and gathering people around a campfire

Art: A travelling pop-up theater experience-- in a box that can open up to become a theater, can reach anywhere, and can also be configured to work on solar energy

Experience:

1. A national competition to tell the stories from the middle east - ted style
2. Pop-up Speakers corner - Community speaks on a topic
3. A travelling group of storytellers that go from town to town
4. Different performances groups can apply to travel with this based on themes that we lay out
5. Free concerts for people as a surprise
6. Afternoon Poetry slams

The Takeaway at the end of the journey - The Treasures Book



A keepsake of their journey through Abu Dhabi and a transformative experience of the values of Islam

Process

Step 1- Creative imagination

Step 2 - Research and Development of Ideas

Step 3 - Turn Idea into blueprints for construction and installation

Step 4 - Turn Blueprints into artwork

Step 5 - Shipment and Installation

Step 6 - Training and documentation